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JOHN J. KIM/CHICAGO TRIBUNE



BALANCING ACT

Refusing ‘position of fear,’ Broadview’s mayor deals with ICE and national spotlight

By Caroline Kubzansky | Chicago Tribune

From a back row of Jordan Temple Church, Katrina Thompson wiped her eyes, got to her feet and raised her hands in prayer as a black-and-white clad choir sang about the excellence of God.

When the Rev. Stephen Richardson took the lectern, she whispered to herself in response to his declaration that “God is not going to let us go down like this.”

“Mayor Thompson, those of you that live in Broadview, Maywood, Proviso Township —” Richardson said. “We’re going to be all right.”

“When we see the military come in—” Richardson said.

“We’re going to be all right,” Thompson repeated.

“When we see the National Guard come in —” Richardson continued.

“We’re going to be all right,” Thompson said again.

Throughout the service Sunday, Thompson’s Apple watch lit up with news notifications and updates from Broadview village staff. The 2.2 square-mile, majority-Black village, where Thompson is in her third term as mayor, has become the locus of what she sees as both a spiritual fight and a political battle.

It had been about a month since chaos erupted outside the U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement processing center just inside Broadview’s village boundary. Confrontations between federal agents and people protesting “Operation Midway Blitz” have put the tiny suburb, and the first Black woman to lead it, under a national spotlight.

They have also forced Thompson into a tough balancing act as agents’ liberal use of chemical crowd controls have disrupted life for many of Broadview’s roughly 8,000 residents. As she’s decried the actions of the federal government and drawn parallels between the anti-ICE protests and the Civil Rights Movement — a cornerstone of her own political upbringing and philosophy — Thompson has also moved to limit demonstration hours outside the facil-

Turn to Mayor, Page 4

Above: Broadview Mayor Katrina Thompson stands in her office Thursday. She is in her third term as mayor. STACEY WESCOTT/TRIBUNE

Pritzker’s victory may not last long

Guard action stopped, but Trump keeps pulling levers of power

By Rick Pearson
Chicago Tribune

The nation has been given a split screen view of Chicago.

On one side, President Donald Trump declares the city a war-torn “hellhole” requiring deployment of National Guard troops to help enforce his administration’s aggressive immigration enforcement efforts as the Department of Homeland Security posts propaganda videos on social media.

On the other, more than a million people, largely tourists from around the world, are gathering across the city and at Grant Park to urge on runners in the Chicago Marathon after tens of thousands had converged in Wrigleyville to cheer on the Cubs.

“This is JB Pritzker reporting from war torn Chicago,” the state’s Democratic governor said Thursday in a mock field report for “Jimmy Kimmel Live!” wearing body armor while walking along a quiet sidewalk on the riverfront’s Wacker Drive.

“As you can see, there’s utter mayhem and chaos on the ground. It’s quite disturbing,” he said. “The Milwaukee Brewers have come in to attack our Chicago Cubs. We’ve seen people being forced to eat hot dogs with ketchup on them and our deep dish pizza, well, has gone shallow. So it’s a challenge

Turn to Pritzker, Page 6

IN CHICAGOLAND:

- Appeals court denies Trump administration request to halt judge’s ruling on National Guard pending appeal. **Page 2**
- Hundreds participate in procession to Broadview ICE facility, condemn detentions and deportations. **Page 2**
- ICE fears ripple across Chicago Public Schools and suburban districts. **Page 3**
- Federal activity has some marathon runners taking extra precautions. **Page 6**

‘Those children adored their dad’

Family of man killed by ICE seeks to reunite with his kids, now in foster care

By Laura Rodríguez Presa
Chicago Tribune

On a recent humid morning in Michoacán, Mexico, hundreds gathered to mourn Silverio Villegas Gonzalez. His body had finally come home after getting shot and killed by an ICE agent in Franklin Park after he allegedly tried to run him over.

The small town where he was born and raised was filled that late September day with neighbors, friends, and relatives, many of whom have family members

working or living in the United States. Among them were Silverio’s elderly parents, dressed in white, leaning on others for support as they made their way through their town, paying homage to Villegas Gonzalez.

Their faces were etched with sorrow; their steps heavy not just from age, but from the weight of a grief that may never leave them. At 38 years old, he was the youngest of their 10 children.

“Mi hijo era un buen hombre. Por qué me lo mataron así?” cried Esperanza Gonzalez, 77, his mother, on

a phone call with Tribune. “My son was a good man. Why did they kill him that way?”

On the day of his burial, as they lowered their son into the ground, one absence loomed larger than the rest: Villegas Gonzalez’s two children were not there.

Villegas Gonzalez was killed by U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement agents on Sept. 12 during what authorities initially described as a routine traffic stop that Villegas Gonzalez tried to flee.

Turn to Family, Page 8



Jorge Villegas holds a framed portrait of his brother, Silverio Villegas Gonzalez, during a procession honoring his memory in Irimbo, Mexico, on Oct. 1. FERNANDO ESPINAL MORENO

Ceasefire in Gaza holds for second day

Thousands of displaced Palestinians returned to their neighborhoods Saturday, and Israelis cheered Monday’s expected release of remaining hostages. **Nation & World**

Will the bye benefit the Bears this year?

The Bears have lost 10 of the last 11 after a bye. Will an early week off — and new coach Ben Johnson — reverse that trend against the Commanders? **Chicago Sports**